

NESS Wonders

Walk the Rose-Red City in Augmented Reality

Welcome to NESS Wonders — an augmented-reality companion for exploring the ancient Nabataean city of Petra, Jordan. This guide explains how to navigate the city in AR, scan monuments, capture and share your visit, plan a route, and track your progress.

Getting Started

Open the app and tap "Enter AR Experience". Your device will request camera access — allow it so the live AR view can render. For the best experience, use NESS Wonders on-site at Petra with a charged phone and good daylight.

Choosing Your Language

NESS Wonders speaks ten languages: English, Chinese, Hindi, Spanish, Arabic, French, Bengali, Portuguese, Russian, and Japanese. Tap the language selector (top-right of any screen) to switch. Monument explanations, audio guides, and the narrator all respond in your chosen language, and the layout adapts for right-to-left Arabic.

Planning Your Route

Before you walk, tap "Plan your route" on the home screen. Choose how long you have — from two hours to a full day — and pick your interests, such as tombs, temples, viewpoints, water works, Byzantine churches, the Roman city, or hiking. NESS Wonders crafts an ordered walking route that fits your time and interests, with a short reason for each stop. Tap "Start in AR" to begin following it.

Navigating in AR

Once inside the AR view, a glowing pink fluorescent line floats ahead of you as a guide path. Follow the line as it curves through the city toward the next points of interest. The line updates as you walk, leading you deeper into Petra.

Scanning Monuments

When you reach a monument, point your camera at it and tap the large pink scan button at the bottom of the screen. NESS Wonders captures the view, recognizes the landmark, and slides up a panel with its name and a concise explanation in your language. Tap the X to close and continue your walk.

Capturing & Sharing Photos

While in the AR view, tap the camera button (to the left of the scan button) to capture a photo of what you see. A preview slides up with Share and Save options. Share sends the photo to your device's share sheet — post it to your favorite social app — while Save downloads it to your gallery. Each capture carries a small NESS Wonders watermark.

Monument Guides & Audio

From the progress map, tap "View guide" on any monument to open its detail page. NESS Wonders generates a tailored explanation in your language on demand and prepares an audio guide you can play right there. Both are cached, so revisiting a monument in the same language plays instantly without regenerating.

Asking the Narrator

Tap "Ask the narrator" to chat with NESS Wonders' historical narrator. It reads the monuments you have discovered and weaves vivid, immersive stories about them — replying in whatever language you write in.

Tracking Your Progress

Tap "Map" in the AR view (or "View progress map" on the home screen) to open a live map of Petra. Each monument you have identified appears as a bright pink pin, while monuments you have not yet discovered appear as faded markers. A progress bar shows how many of the 100 scannable points you have found.

100 Scannable Points

NESS Wonders recognizes 100 significant points across Petra — from the Siq and the Treasury to the Monastery, the Royal Tombs, the Theatre, the High Place of Sacrifice, the Temenos Gate, the Nymphaeum, and many lesser-known tombs, temples, waterworks, and viewpoints. Keep scanning to complete your collection.

Tips for Great Scans

Hold the phone steady and frame the monument squarely in the camera. Good, even daylight gives the clearest recognition. If a scan is not recognized, step slightly to one side or move closer and try again.

Safety & Respect

Stay on marked paths and do not climb on or touch the fragile carvings. Petra is a UNESCO World Heritage Site — treat it with care. Carry water, wear sun protection, and watch your footing on uneven stone. The app is a guide; your own judgment keeps you safe.